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Technical Specification

3rd Generation Partnership Project; Technical Specification Group Services and System Aspects; 5G Security Assurance Specification (SCAS) for the Network Exposure Function (NEF) network product class (Release 20)





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3GPP

Postal address

3GPP support office address
650 Route des Lucioles - Sophia Antipolis
Valbonne - FRANCE
Tel.: +33 4 92 94 42 00 Fax: +33 4 93 65 47 16

Internet
http://www.3gpp.org

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Foreword

This Technical Specification has been produced by the 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP).

The contents of the present document are subject to continuing work within the TSG and may change following formal TSG approval. Should the TSG modify the contents of the present document, it will be re-released by the TSG with an identifying change of release date and an increase in version number as follows:

Version x.y.z

where:

- x the first digit:
  - 1 presented to TSG for information;
  - 2 presented to TSG for approval;
  - 3 or greater indicates TSG approved document under change control.
- y the second digit is incremented for all changes of substance, i.e. technical enhancements, corrections, updates, etc.
- z the third digit is incremented when editorial only changes have been incorporated in the document.

In the present document, modal verbs have the following meanings:

shall indicates a mandatory requirement to do something

shall not indicates an interdiction (prohibition) to do something

The constructions "shall" and "shall not" are confined to the context of normative provisions, and do not appear in Technical Reports.

The constructions "must" and "must not" are not used as substitutes for "shall" and "shall not". Their use is avoided insofar as possible, and they are not used in a normative context except in a direct citation from an external, referenced, non-3GPP document, or so as to maintain continuity of style when extending or modifying the provisions of such a referenced document.

should indicates a recommendation to do something

should not indicates a recommendation not to do something

may indicates permission to do something

need not indicates permission not to do something

The construction "may not" is ambiguous and is not used in normative elements. The unambiguous constructions "might not" or "shall not" are used instead, depending upon the meaning intended.

can indicates that something is possible

cannot indicates that something is impossible

The constructions "can" and "cannot" are not substitutes for "may" and "need not".

will indicates that something is certain or expected to happen as a result of action taken by an agency the behaviour of which is outside the scope of the present document

will not indicates that something is certain or expected not to happen as a result of action taken by an agency the behaviour of which is outside the scope of the present document

might indicates a likelihood that something will happen as a result of action taken by some agency the behaviour of which is outside the scope of the present document

might not indicates a likelihood that something will not happen as a result of action taken by some agency the behaviour of which is outside the scope of the present document

In addition:

is (or any other verb in the indicative mood) indicates a statement of fact

is not (or any other negative verb in the indicative mood) indicates a statement of fact

The constructions "is" and "is not" do not indicate requirements.

1 Scope

The present document contains requirements and test cases that are specific to the NEF network product class. It refers to the Catalogue of General Security Assurance Requirements and formulates specific adaptions of the requirements and test cases given there, as well as specifying requirements and test cases unique to the NEF network product class.

2 References

The following documents contain provisions which, through reference in this text, constitute provisions of the present document.

- References are either specific (identified by date of publication, edition number, version number, etc.) or non-specific.
- For a specific reference, subsequent revisions do not apply.
- For a non-specific reference, the latest version applies. In the case of a reference to a 3GPP document (including a GSM document), a non-specific reference implicitly refers to the latest version of that document *in the same Release as the present document*.

[1] 3GPP TS 21.905: "Vocabulary for 3GPP Specifications".

[2] 3GPP TS 33.501: "Security architecture and procedures for 5G system".

[3] 3GPP TS 23.501: "System Architecture for the 5G System".

[4] 3GPP TS 33.122: " Security aspects of Common API Framework (CAPIF) for 3GPP northbound APIs".

[5] 3GPP TR 33.926: "Security Assurance Specification (SCAS) threats and critical assets in 3GPP network product classes".

[6] 3GPP TS 33.117: "Catalogue of general security assurance requirements".

[7] 3GPP TS 33.210: "Network Domain Security (NDS); IP network layer security".

[8] IETF RFC 6749: "The OAuth 2.0 Authorization Framework".

3 Definitions of terms, symbols and abbreviations

3.1 Terms

For the purposes of the present document, the terms given in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1] and the following apply. A term defined in the present document takes precedence over the definition of the same term, if any, in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1].

3.2 Symbols

Void.

3.3 Abbreviations

For the purposes of the present document, the abbreviations given in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1] and the following apply. An abbreviation defined in the present document takes precedence over the definition of the same abbreviation, if any, in 3GPP TR 21.905 [1].

CAPIF	Common API Framework for 3GPP northbound APIs
NEF	Network Exposure Function

4 NEF-specific security requirements and related test cases

4.1 Introduction

NEF specific security requirements include both requirements derived from NEF-specific security functional requirements as well as security requirements derived from threats specific to NEF as described in TR 33.926 [5]. Generic security requirements and test cases common to other network product classes have been captured in TS 33.117 [6] and are not repeated in the present document.

4.2 NEF-specific security functional adaptations of requirements and related test cases

4.2.0 Introduction

The present clause describes the security functional requirements and the corresponding test cases for NEF network product class. The proposed security requirements are classified in two groups:

- Security functional requirements derived from TS 33.501 [2] and detailed in clause 4.2.2.
- General security functional requirements which include requirements not already addressed in TS 33.501 [2] but whose support is also important to ensure that NEF conforms to a common security baseline detailed in clause 4.2.3.

4.2.1 Void

4.2.2 Security functional requirements on the NEF deriving from 3GPP specifications and related test cases

4.2.2.0 General

The general approach in TS 33.117 [3] clause 4.2.2.1 and all the requirements and test cases in TS 33.117 [3] clause 4.2.2.2 related to SBA/SBI aspect apply to the NEF network product class.

4.2.2.1 Security functional requirements on the NEF deriving from 3GPP specifications – TS 33.501 [2]

4.2.2.1.1 Authentication on application function

Requirement Name: Authentication on application function

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.9.2.3, and clause 12.2

Requirement Description: Mutual authentication between the NEF and Application Function is supported as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 5.9.2.3. For authentication between NEF and an Application Function that resides outside the 3GPP operator domain, mutual authentication based on client and server certificates is performed between the NEF and AF using TLS and Certificate based authentication follows the profiles given in TS 33.210 [7], clause 6.2 as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 12.2.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause I.2.2.1, No authentication on application function

Test Case*:*

Test Name: TC_CP_AUTH_AF_NEF

Purpose: To verify that the NEF can authenticate application function and establish TLS connection towards the application server with certificate based authentication, and may authenticate application function and establish TLS connection towards the application server with pre-shared key based authentication.

Pre-Condition:

- The NEF network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments.
- In order to establish TLS connections to the NEF network product, the application function shall offer a feature that is supported by the NEF network product, including protocol version and combination of cryptographic algorithms.
- The application function and the NEF network product shall support certificate based authentication, and may support pre-shared key based authentication.
- If the NEF network product does not support CAPIF as specified in clause 6.2.5.1 in TS 23.501 [3], the certificates or the pre-shared key shall be provisioned in the NEF network product.
- If the NEF network product supports CAPIF, the certificates or the pre-shared key shall be provisioned in the CAPIF core function, the CAPIF core function shall be able to select appropriate authentication method as defined in the sub-clause 6.5.2 in TS 33.122 [4].

Execution Steps:

1. If certificate based authentication is used, provision correct certificate on the application function, if pre-shared key based authentication is used, provision same pre-shared key on the application function.
2. The application function shall initiate establishment of TLS connection towards the NEF network product, and check whether a TLS connection is established successfully.
3. If certificate based authentication is used, provision incorrect certificate on the application function, if pre-shared key based authentication is used, provision different pre-shared key on the application function.
4. The application function shall initiate establishment of TLS connection towards the NEF network product, and check whether no new TLS connection is established.

Expected Results:

Only one TLS connection is established at step 2.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g., Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.2.1.2 Authorization on northbound APIs

Requirement Name: Authorization on application function

Requirement Reference: TS 33.501 [2], clause 12.4

Requirement Description: The NEF authorizes the requests from Application Function using OAuth-based authorization mechanism, the specific authorization mechanisms follow the provisions given in RFC 6749 [8], as specified in TS 33.501 [2], clause 12.4.

Threat References: TR 33.926 [5], clause I.2.2.2, No authorization on northbound APIs

***Test Case**:*

Test Name: TC_CP_AUTHOR_AF_NEF

Purpose: To verify that the NEF can authorize application function.

Pre-Condition:

- The NEF network product shall be connected in emulated/real network environments.
- The application function and the NEF network product shall support OAuth-based authorization mechanism.
- An authorization server (e.g. NRF, or CAPIF core function) that supports OAuth2 protocol to authorize NEF northbound APIs using the "Client Credentials" authorization grant has been deployed.
- The TLS connection between the NEF network product and the application function has been established.
- The authorization server is configured to grant the application function access to a specific northbound API of the NEF network product, called NEF northbound API A, using access tokens that are scoped to individual NEF northbound APIs (i.e. a token for API A is not valid for API B).

Execution Steps:

Test 1: valid token:

1. The application function invokes Obtain_Authorization service towards the authorization server to get a token from the authorization server for accessing the NEF northbound API A.
2. The tester triggers the application function to invoke northbound API A of the NEF network product with a valid token for API A.

Test 2: without token:

1. The tester triggers the application function to invoke northbound API A of the NEF network product without a token.

Test 3: with incorrect token:

1. The tester triggers the application function to invoke the NEF northbound API A with an incorrect token.

Test 4: with correct token for different API:

1. The application function invokes Obtain_Authorization service towards the authorization server to get a token from the authorization server for accessing the NEF northbound API A.
2. The tester triggers the application function to invoke another NEF northbound API B with a valid token for API A.

Expected Results:

The invocation of NEF northbound API A succeeds in Test 1 and fails in Test 2 to Test 4.

Expected format of evidence:

Evidence suitable for the interface, e.g., Screenshot containing the operational results.

4.2.3 Technical Baseline

4.2.3.1 Introduction

The present clause provides baseline technical requirements.

4.2.3.2 Protecting data and information

4.2.3.2.1 Protecting data and information – general

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.1 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.2.2 Protecting data and information – unauthorized viewing

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.2 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.2.3 Protecting data and information in storage

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.3 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.2.4 Protecting data and information in transfer

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.4 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.2.5 Logging access to personal data

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.2.5 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.3 Protecting availability and integrity

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.3 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.4 Authentication and authorization

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.4 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.5 Protecting sessions

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.5 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.3.6 Logging

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.3.6 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.4 Operating Systems

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.4 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.5 Web Servers

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.5 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.6 Network Devices

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.2.6 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.2.7 Void

4.3 NEF-specific adaptations of hardening requirements and related test cases

4.3.1 Introduction

The requirements proposed hereafter (with the relative test cases) aim to securing NEF by reducing its surface of vulnerability. In particular, the identified requirements aim to ensure that all the default configurations of NEF (including operating system software, firmware and applications) are appropriately set.

4.3.2 Technical baseline

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.3.2 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.3.3 Operating systems

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.3.3 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.3.4 Web servers

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.3.4 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.3.5 Network devices

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.3.5 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.3.6 Network functions in service-based architecture

There are no NEF-specific additions to clause 4.3.6 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.4 NEF-specific adaptations of basic vulnerability testing requirements and related test cases

4.4.1 Introduction

There are no NEF specific addtions to clause 4.4.1 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.4.2 Port Scanning

There are no NEF specific addtions to clause 4.4.2 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.4.3 Vulnerability scanning

There are no NEF specific addtions to clause 4.4.3 of TS 33.117 [6].

4.4.4 Robustness and fuzz testing

The test cases under clause 4.4.4 of TS 33.117 [6] are applicable to NEF.

The interface defined for the NEF are in 4.2.3 of TS 23.501 [3].

According to clause 4.4.4 of TS 33.117 [6], the transport protocols available on the interfaces providing IP-based protocols need to be robustness tested. Following TCP/IP layer model and considering all the protocols over transport layer, for NEF, the following interface and protocols are in the scope of the testing:

- For Nnef: the TLS, TCP, HTTP2 and JSON protocols.

NOTE: There could be other interfaces and/or protocols requiring testing under clause 4.4.4 of TS 33.117 [6]

Annex A (informative): Change history

Change history							
Date	**Meeting**	**TDoc**	**CR**	**Rev**	**Cat**	**Subject/Comment**	**New version**
2019-09	SA#85					Change control version	16.0.0
2019-10						EditHelp review	16.0.1
2019-12	SA#86	SP-191138	0002	1	F	Corrections for clean-up and alignment	16.1.0
2020-12	Sa#90E	SP-201004	0003	-	F	Reference of general SBA/SBI aspect in 33.519	16.2.0
2022-03	-	-	-	-	-	Update to Rel-17 version (MCC)	17.0.0
2023-06	SA#100	SP-230677	0004	1	B	Robustness interfaces and protocols defined for NEF	18.0.0
2023-06	SA#100	SP-230677	0005	1	F	SCAS release reference corrections	18.0.0
2025-10	-	-	-	-	-	Update to Rel-19 version (MCC)	19.0.0
2026-03	SA#111	SP-260161	0007	-	F	Add TLS to the robustness and fuzz testing to TS 33.519	20.0.0
2026-06	SA#112	SP-260498	0008	-	F	Correction of TC_CP_AUTHOR_AF_NEF	20.1.0